

Prayers for our World and the Church

including Prayer of Confession

29th March 2026

Psalm 4:5-8 [5] *Offer right sacrifices, and put your trust in the Lord. [6] There are many who say, "Who will show us some good? Lift up the light of your face upon us, O Lord!" [7] You have put more joy in my heart than they have when their grain and wine abound. [8] In peace I will both lie down and sleep; for you alone, O Lord, make me dwell in safety.*

As we approach the commemoration of the death and resurrection of our Lord and Saviour, we come to a time of prayer, to acknowledge God's greatness, His perfection, to confess our imperfection and need of Jesus' sacrifice, and to bring our requests to Him Who alone is able to effect lasting change, according to His purposes for the world and for us within it.

Adoration

God Almighty, Father, Son and Holy Spirit, Creator of all that is, we Your creatures come before You only because You are merciful, faithful and righteous. From everlasting to everlasting, You alone are God, all-powerful, all-seeing, all-holy and altogether just! If we were to rely on Your justice, we would be lost, for we could never offer right sacrifices, because we are warped by sin into self-centredness, and we would not seek You or put our trust in You.

Confession

But because You are all-loving, and graciously merciful, we are not destroyed. We look back upon our week and confess the times when we have failed, when we have not been holy as You are holy, when we have shamed the Name of Jesus, when we have put down another person, thinking more of ourselves, when we have given in to temptation. We are ashamed of our thoughts, words and deeds and freely confess them to You now.

Thanksgiving

Now we thank You that You have not abandoned us, but rescued us. We thank You for the special grace of salvation: while we were still sinners, Jesus came as the Sinless, Son of Man to take our place and suffer the penalty which we deserved, dying in our stead so we could go free.

We thank You that You have lifted up the light of Your face upon us. We thank You that we now have joy in our hearts, and peace in our relationship with You.

Supplication: The Wider World

In the wider world, we continue to pray for the nations at war and for the people caught by the conflicts which have been started by others. We pray for believers in those places, and for Your people in churches nearby, who seek to provide for the refugees escaping from the war zones.

... and the wider Church

We pray also for Your people in churches around the world as they support missionaries to those conflict zones. We thank You for Lazlo and Eva Mihalyi and the work they have been doing in Hungary and Rumania. As they return home, we pray for their safe travel and their transition to Australian life. We pray You would provide new workers to take their place so that Your witness may continue.

Supplication: Ashburton

Here in Ashburton we pray for David Hann as he preaches Your Word, and we pray for our own understanding as we listen. May we be transformed by the renewing of our minds so that Your living Word goes deep into our hearts. Holy Spirit, we pray that You would change us so that we live our lives more and more in conformity to Your Word. We pray that our fellowship continues to grow stronger each week, both in Sunday worship and in our community groups.

Finally, we pray for ourselves in the service of the Kingdom. We thank You that we are a part of the work of spreading the Good News, and members of the worldwide Body of Christ. May we grow to show the character of our Risen Lord so well that others will see Him rather than us.